



Judith F. Baca altering a portrait of Cesar Chavez on a mural in Santa Monica, Calif., after revelations of sexual misconduct emerged.

## With Chavez’s Legacy Stained, What to Do With Art in Tribute?

By TIM ARANGO

Los Angeles is a city of public art, and perhaps no work is more far-reaching and ambitious than the artist Judith F. Baca’s “Great Wall of Los Angeles,” a half-mile-long mural that portrays California and American history from prehistoric times to the 1950s. An expansion that is underway will add another half mile and complete the story, bringing it up to modern times.

That means Cesar Chavez is about to enter the picture.

Along the walls of Ms. Baca’s cavernous studio in Santa Monica are canvas panels for the 1960s: colorful depictions of the civil rights era, the Vietnam War and the farmworkers’ movement led by Mr. Chavez. When the paintings are completed — the public

### Murals and Monuments Are Now Seen in a Dimmer Light

has been invited in to watch their creation — the panels will be installed on the concrete wall of the Tujunga Wash, a tributary of the Los Angeles River, in the San Fernando Valley.

Mr. Chavez was painted before The New York Times published detailed allegations that he had sexually abused young girls and raped another union leader, Dolores Huerta. In response to the revelations, some cities and institutions in California and across the country have been quick to re-

Continued on Page A16

## World-Famous Piano Prodigy Who Overcame Father’s Abuse

By MARGALIT FOX

Josef Slenczynski lay on the battlefield and bargained.

A down-at-the-heels young man from Poland who had come to the United States not long before, Mr. Slenczynski was serving in World War I with the American Expeditionary Forces in Europe. In civilian life, he was a violinist of large ambition but no large reputation, and now he lay in his own blood, his left wrist shattered by shrapnel.

If God would only spare his life, he vowed, he would redeem his lost career by fathering and training the greatest musician the world had ever known.

Mr. Slenczynski kept his word, or tried to. For much of the 1930s, until the toll his methods exacted nearly consumed her, his daughter Ruth was one of the most celebrated child prodigies of her time, performing worldwide on a grand piano with its legs shortened to accommodate hers — a Mozart in bobby socks and pinafores.

Known from young adulthood on as Ruth Slenczynska (pronounced slen-CHIN-ska), she ultimately made a life outside the lucrative limelight her father craved for her, building a quiet, highly re-



JAMES J. KRIEGSMANN, VIA BETTMANN ARCHIVE/GETTY IMAGES

Ruth Slenczynska in 1957.

spected career as a teacher, performer and recording artist.

The truly remarkable thing is that Ms. Slenczynska was able to make a life, in or out of music, at all. For after submitting for years to a punishing practice schedule, withheld nourishment, verbal abuse and physical violence — a regime that on its glittering surface made her a darling of the press, carried her to the world’s most celebrated concert stages and had her hobnobbing with film

Continued on Page B12

## The War in Iran Has Morphed From Bombs to a Test of Wills

By ANTON TROIANOVSKI

WASHINGTON — On Thursday morning, Washington time, a senior Iranian official wrote on X that the country’s fighters were hiding in sea caves near the Strait of Hormuz, preparing to “devastate the aggressors.”

Eighteen minutes later, President Trump posted on Truth Social: “I have ordered the United States Navy to shoot and kill any boat” that is “putting mines in the waters of the Strait of Hormuz.”

Mr. Trump’s war on Iran, interrupted by a cease-fire that he extended indefinitely this week, has morphed from all-out bombardment to a volatile, costly standoff at the mouth of the Persian Gulf.

Neither side appears eager to return to the violence that ensnared much of the Middle East before the April 7 cease-fire, though both insist they are ready for it. And neither side is showing signs of capitulating to the other’s demands. The result is round after

Continued on Page A6

**NEGOTIATIONS** The U.S. said Jared Kushner and Steve Witkoff would travel to Pakistan to resume talks on Iran, while Vice President JD Vance stayed back. PAGE A6

## Musk Borrowed \$500 Million From SpaceX

By SUSANNE CRAIG and KIRSTEN GRIND

In January 2018, Elon Musk needed \$100 million. Instead of calling a bank, he turned to SpaceX, the rocket company he founded and where he serves as chief executive.

Over the next three years, Mr. Musk borrowed a total of \$500 million from his company. The loan terms were significantly lower than what most banks offered, with an interest rate that fluctuated from less than 1 percent to nearly 3 percent, according to internal SpaceX documents obtained by The New York Times. The documents did not say how Mr. Musk planned to use the money, which he paid back to SpaceX by the end of 2021.

The loans and their exceptionally kind terms, which are not permitted at public companies, were possible only because SpaceX is privately held. They were just one way Mr. Musk has used SpaceX as a kind of piggy bank over the last two decades, according to an examination by The Times based on corporate filings, lawsuits, internal documents and interviews with people close to the firm.

Continued on Page A14



DAVID GUTTENFELDER/THE NEW YORK TIMES

### Bringing Lebanon’s Dead Home Amid Cease-Fire

Exhuming a coffin from Qana, in the south, for reburial in the victim’s neighboring village.

## Demand for Trump Warship Doomed Navy Chief

By GREG JAFFE and HELENE COOPER

WASHINGTON — President Trump wanted one thing, more than anything else, from his secretary of the Navy, John Phelan: a new class of battleships.

“They’ll be the fastest, the biggest and by far — 100 times more powerful than any battleship ever built,” Mr. Trump boasted at a

### Assigned to a Task Seen as Nearly Impossible

news conference at his Mar-a-Lago estate and resort in Florida a few days before Christmas. Mr. Phelan, a billionaire investor who has a home near the club, stood next to the president as he made

the announcement.

Mr. Phelan’s job was to deliver the first of Mr. Trump’s battleships by 2028.

On Wednesday, Mr. Trump fired Mr. Phelan, who had struggled to come up with a plan to deliver the ships on the nearly impossible timeline that Mr. Trump has demanded, senior defense and administration officials said, speaking.

Continued on Page A12



INTERNATIONAL A4-10

**New Tone on Africa Trip**

Pope Leo XIV made some of his most forthright comments, but was uneasy at how they were interpreted. PAGE A4

**Suspicious Temperature Spikes**

A Paris airport weather sensor may have been tampered with as large wagers were placed online. PAGE A8

NATIONAL A11-17

**Hurdle in Haaland’s Run**

The former interior secretary Deb Haaland seemed like a shoo-in for governor of New Mexico until a local prosecutor challenged her. PAGE A11

**Guilty Verdict in 1993 Slaying**

After three trials and many twists, a suspect was found guilty in a grisly suburban Buffalo murder. PAGE A17

SPORTS B7-10

**Dubious Battles to Fight**

Everyone around the N.H.L. wants more clean hits. So why are players so often forced to scrap afterward? PAGE B7



ARTS C1-6

**Hathaway Is Set to Vibe**

The actress plays a tortured pop star in “Mother Mary” and is in playful form in “The Devil Wears Prada 2.” PAGE C1

**Turnabout on Michael Jackson**

The Cascio siblings, the pop star’s “second family,” are suing his estate, saying he sexually assaulted them. PAGE C1

BUSINESS B1-6

**Who Deserves Tariff Refund?**

Many families felt the sting of the president’s now-illegal tariffs, but importers and other companies have said little about whether they will share the \$166 billion coming back to them. PAGE B1

**Private Assets in Your 401(k)**

They boost returns and further diversify retirement dollars, but these alternative investments are costly, opaque and not easy to unload — the polar opposite of a beloved index fund. PAGE B1

OPINION A18-19

**Eswar Prasad** PAGE A18

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